

Murali Sreeshankar

Murali Sreeshankar enters Aichi-Nagoya as India's clearest long jump favourite. He lost the Hangzhou title by three centimetres, taking silver with 8.19m, and has returned from knee surgery at a level capable of reversing that result. His 8.38m victory at the National Inter-State Championships leads Asia this season and is the second-best jump of his career. He then took Commonwealth Games silver with 8.09m, confirming that the domestic breakthrough

was not an isolated performance. China's Yuan Chenlong has reached 8.33m in 2026, while Japan has selected Yuki Hashioka, an 8.36m performer whose season's best is 8.22m, and Riku Ito. Shi Yuhao, China's other entrant, has jumped 8.14m, while India's Shahnaz Khan adds another serious medal threat at 8.30m. The decisive issue is board accuracy. A legal opening jump beyond 8.20m should place Sreeshankar immediately and firmly in control of a field in which he owns the strongest recent performance.

MEN'S
LONG JUMP